

Connect Claude to Your Lofty CRM

A quick-start guide for real estate agents and VAs

What this is

A Claude skill that turns Claude Desktop into a working operator for your Lofty CRM. Once installed, you can ask Claude in plain English to find leads, log notes, pull a client's activity feed, and run common workflows. Setup takes about 15 minutes, then you are off to the races.

What you can do once connected

- Find a lead by name and pull their full record
- Log notes on the right lead with a confirmation step before posting
- See a buyer's recent browses, searches, and favorites
- Pull your team, your tags, and your active webhooks
- Get plain-English answers to Lofty errors and quirks
- Extend the skill over time to handle showings, MLS search, and automation

Download the skill file (.skill)

Or browse the project: github.com/Joe-exprealty/lofty-cowork-skill

What you'll need

Make sure you have all of these before starting setup. The skill cannot work around a missing prerequisite.

A computer. Mac (macOS 14 or newer), Windows 10 or 11, or Linux. All three are supported.

Python 3.11 or newer. On Mac and Linux, check with `python3 --version`. On Windows, use `python --version` in PowerShell.

Claude Desktop with Cowork mode. Available for Mac and Windows. Download from claude.ai. If Cowork is not visible in the app, your account may need it enabled.

A Lofty account with API access. Verify by going to Settings, then API Keys, and confirming you can see a Generate button.

A code editor that handles dotfiles. VS Code or Cursor on any platform. On Windows, do not use plain Notepad; it can mangle `.env` files.

The `.skill` file. Click the download button above, or use this direct link: lofty-cowork-helper.skill

Platform notes

Windows: the Python command is `python` (or `py`), not `python3`. Use PowerShell or Windows Terminal, not the older Command Prompt. Where this guide says `~/Code/lofty-tools`, Windows users should use `$HOME\Code\lofty-tools` in PowerShell.

Linux: works the same as Mac. Use your distro's package manager and your usual terminal.

Setup, step by step

Step 1: Download the skill

Click the download button on page 1, or use this link directly: lofty-cowork-helper.skill. Save the file somewhere you can find it (Downloads folder is fine).

Step 2: Install the skill in Claude Desktop

Open Claude Desktop. Look for a Skills or Plugins panel in settings. Drag the .skill file into it, or use the "Install from file" option. After install, the skill lives in your Claude plugins directory automatically.

Step 3: Confirm it installed

Open a new Cowork conversation and type: *"Do you have a Lofty skill installed?"* Claude should mention lofty-cowork-helper.

Step 4: Pick a workspace folder

In Terminal (Mac/Linux) or PowerShell (Windows), run:

```
Mac / Linux:
mkdir -p ~/Code/lofty-tools

Windows (PowerShell):
New-Item -ItemType Directory -Force -Path "$HOME\Code\lofty-tools"
```

Then in Claude Desktop, point Cowork at that folder.

Step 5: Ask Claude to run setup

In your Cowork session, type:

```
"Set up Lofty for the first time."
```

The skill walks you through getting your Lofty API key, creating the workspace structure, customizing your CLAUDE.md context file, pasting your API key into .env, and running the connection test. About 10 minutes including the Lofty side.

Step 6: Verify it works

Once setup is complete, try these prompts to confirm everything is connected:

- "Find my most recent Lofty leads"
- "Show me the activity for lead [name or ID]"
- "Log a test note on lead [ID] saying 'connection check'"

What you can ask for

Once the skill is installed, you can talk to Claude in plain English. It triggers automatically when you mention Lofty. Here are common patterns:

"Find Jane Smith in Lofty"

Returns the matching lead with their contact info.

"Show me Jane's recent activity"

Pulls the last 20 browse / search / favorite events.

"Log a note on Jane's lead saying we discussed pricing today"

Drafts the note, asks you to confirm, then posts it.

"Pull my recent Lofty leads"

Returns your 25 most recently created leads.

"Show me my Lofty team / tags / webhooks"

Self-explanatory.

"What does Lofty error 200058 mean?"

Quirk lookup. Same for any error code.

"How do I extend this for showings?"

Walks you through adding the showing scheduler.

Safety habits

Build these habits from day one. They are baked into how the skill operates, but knowing them up front helps you understand what Claude is doing.

- **Confirm before sending email or SMS.** Always. Claude will draft and ask before sending.
- **Confirm before deleting anything.** Same idea. The Lofty UI does not have an undo.
- **Never paste your API key into chat.** Treat it like a password.
- **Verify the lead ID before logging a note.** A name match could be the wrong person.
- **Times use ISO 8601 with offset.** Pacific is -07:00 in DST, -08:00 outside.
- **Address format Lofty expects:** STREET, CITY, STATE ZIP.

Top 5 Lofty API quirks

These are the behaviors that surprised us during testing. The skill handles all of them automatically, but knowing them helps you understand any error you might see.

Auth header is token, not Bearer.

Mixing it up returns error 200058.

/v1.0/leads silently ignores keyword and sort.

The skill uses a leads index workaround.

Activities must use v1.0.

The v2.0 endpoint returns empty results.

Notes go to POST /v1.0/notes with leadId in the body.

The intuitive /v1.0/leads/<id>/notes path returns 404.

Rate limit is 10 requests per minute.

The starter client enforces 6.5s spacing.

The full list of 14 documented quirks lives in [the comprehensive guide](#) on GitHub.

Where to get help

If something does not work, the skill itself is the first place to ask. Just type your error message into Cowork and Claude will walk you through the troubleshooting decision tree. For deeper help:

- Repository (source, issues, releases): github.com/Joe-exprealty/lofty-cowork-skill
- Install guide (web): [INSTALL.md](#)
- Comprehensive guide (web): [full-guide.md](#)
- Direct .skill download: [latest .skill file](#)

About this project

Built by Joe Saling, Saling Homes at eXp Realty, after months of trial and error connecting Lofty to Claude. The skill is open source under the MIT License. It is provided as is; verify behavior in your own Lofty account before relying on it for client-facing work.

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